SMC

System Management Controller

Beta release | Open-source RTL | Apache 2.0

HIGHLIGHTS

- Four-core Rocket RV64GC management processor subsystem
- 56-bit-address, 64-bit-data AXI fabric with programmable filtering and remap
- Clock, reset, power-good, interrupt, mailbox, and subsystem-control integration
- GPIO, I2C, UART, SPI, AVSBus, telemetry, watchdog, and timer peripherals
- DMA controller with linear and 2D transfers
- Direct integration paths for OCAH DTP and SEP subsystems
- Typed boundaries for adopter memories, OTP, pads, PVT, PLL, and trace macros

SYSTEM ROLE

The System Management Controller (SMC) is a subsystem in a chiplet that takes on system management tasks, including managing clock, voltage, and reset, configuring the hardware platform, bringing up the system, and reporting system status. Each chiplet's essential functions are managed by its own SMC. SMCs are arranged hierarchically within a multi-chiplet device, with one SMC assigned a primary management role.

OVERVIEW

The System Management Controller combines a four-core Rocket CPU cluster, local memories, AXI and AXI4-Lite fabrics, interrupt handling, reset controls, and management peripherals. The supported configuration supplies 1 MiB of banked scratch memory, a 128 KiB boot-ROM interface, and 256 external interrupt inputs.

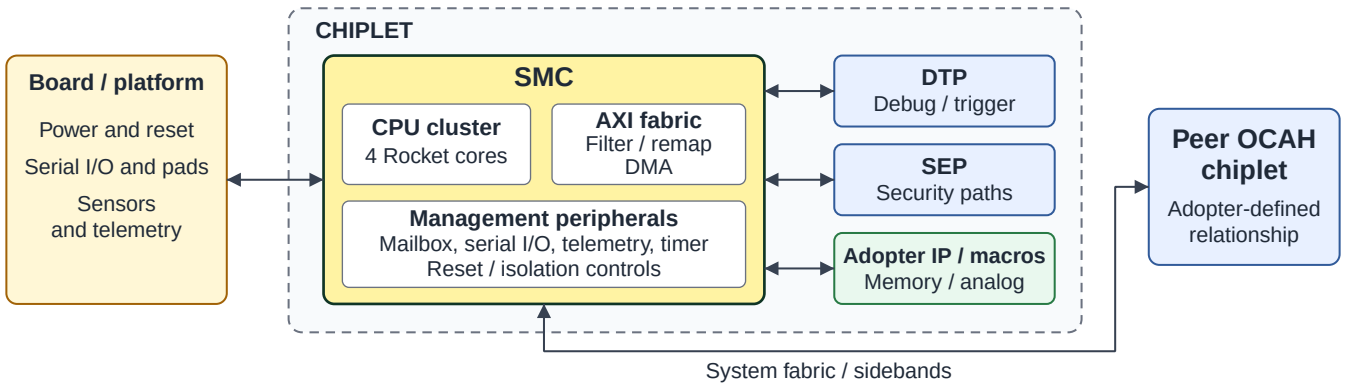
Inbound system, JTAG-debug, and SEP traffic reaches SMC resources through the input fabric. SMC-generated traffic leaves through programmable filter and remap stages. Dedicated interfaces connect DTP control and cross-trigger paths, SEP traffic and mailbox events, external management registers, subsystem reset and isolation controls, and adopter-supplied physical or memory macros. The release does not prescribe macro implementations, a final address map, or chiplet-management policy.

AT A GLANCE

Feature	Description
Processor cluster	4 Rocket RV64GC cores
System AXI	56-bit address, 64-bit data
Scratch memory	1 MiB across 32 banks
Boot ROM	128 KiB interface
External interrupt inputs	256
Platform I/O	65 GPIO wrappers (61 bonded, 4 unbonded); 3 I2C; 4 UART
Telemetry inputs	3 receivers
Control fanout	32 mailboxes with 32 mailbox interrupts; 32 subsystem reset/isolation slots

Values summarize the default `smc_pkg::SMC_4CORE` selection. Memory instances, pad cells, analog functions, and clock implementation are integration-specific.

SYSTEM CONTEXT



Dashed boundary: one chiplet. Clocks, macros, Boot ROM, address map and management policy are adopter-defined.

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CAPABILITIES

Management compute and memory

- Rocket RV64GC cluster with local interrupt controllers and bus-error reporting
- External boot-ROM, scratch, cache, and trace-memory macro interfaces
- One instantiated DMA controller
- Memory zeroer for initialization and zeroing

Fabric and control

- Independent system, JTAG-debug, and SEP AXI inputs
- Outbound AXI path with configurable address filtering, privilege-aware remap, alias remap, isolation, and error handling
- Mailboxes, watchdogs, a 64-bit Open Chiplet Time Synchronization (OCTS) timer, cross-trigger connections, and 32 subsystem reset/isolation control slots

Management peripherals

- GPIO; I2C, UART, SPI, and AVSBus controller integration
- Telemetry receivers and interfaces for OTP, PVT, PLL, clock-generation, trace, and pad-ring functions

INTERFACES AND CONFIGURATION

Feature	Integration options
Clocks and resets	SMC, reference, peripheral, and telemetry clocks; power-good, primary-reset, warm-reset, scan/test, and synchronized reset connections
System fabric	56-bit/64-bit AXI system input and output; separate JTAG and SEP inputs; 32-bit local AXI4-Lite register boundaries
OCAH subsystems	DTP CSR/reset/cross-trigger paths and SEP AXI, mailbox, and watchdog paths
Platform controls	External interrupts, mailbox interrupts, OCTS count, reset/isolation fanout, serial interfaces, GPIO, and telemetry
Technology macros	Boot ROM, scratch/cache/trace memories, OTP, pad ring, PVT, PLL, and clock-generation interfaces
Build-time	Checked-in four-core cluster build, AXI types, memory types, peripheral configuration, and technology-specific cell implementations

RESOURCES

Documentation: docs.tenstorrent.com/tt-oca-harness
SMC source documentation: `hw/sys/smc/doc/`
RTL: `hw/sys/smc/rtl/`
Verification: `hw/sys/smc/dv/`
Boot-ROM collateral: `hw/sys/smc/bootrom/prod/`
Synthesis collateral: `hw/sys/smc/synth/`
Integrator Guide: `doc/integrator/`
Project: github.com/tenstorrent/tt-oca-harness

INTEGRATION DEPENDENCIES

- Record the supported four-core CPU cluster, memory implementations, peripheral instances, and all generated register collateral used by the build.
- Provide clock, reset, power-good, CDC, test, and clock-gating integration; verify reset completion and isolation handshakes for every connected subsystem.
- Integrate the boot ROM, scratch/cache/trace memories, OTP, pads, PVT, PLL, and other technology-dependent boundaries, including initialization and repair behavior required by the selected macros.
- Define the system address map and program the outbound filters, remap regions, privilege policy, error handling, and unused-interface tie-offs.
- Integrate and validate the checked-in production Boot ROM image for the selected memory implementation and product boot policy.
- Connect DTP, SEP, platform interrupts, reset/isolation controls, and external peripherals according to the product's lifecycle and security policy.

VERIFICATION AND MATURITY

The OCAH verification dashboard publishes the current verification and maturity status. The checked-in open-source cocotb/PyUVM environment runs against the SMC integration wrapper, which combines SMC RTL, adopter-facing IP shims, and CPU memories. Credited scenarios exercise reset and power-good behavior, CSRs, mailboxes, local fabric, function-level reset, I2C, iJTAG, CPU-to-SEP traffic, OTP observation, GPIO interrupts, AVSBus registers, UART/SPI/log-engine registers, DMA timeout, filter/remap paths, and multi-reset persistence.

A candidate traceability matrix is available. The silicon integrator must select the detailed peripheral configuration and update DV accordingly. No silicon characterization or portable frequency, performance, area, or power figures are claimed.

DELIVERABLES

- SystemVerilog RTL, generated Rocket-cluster RTL, wrappers, and dependency filelists
- SystemRDL-derived register collateral and configuration packages
- Architecture, interface, memory-map, integration, and verification documentation
- Open-source cocotb/PyUVM tests plus a smaller SV-UVM scenario set
- Production Boot ROM source, build flow, and documentation
- Synthesis and CDC/timing-constraint starting points
- Apache License 2.0 repository distribution

TERMS

OCTS: open chiplet time synchronization. OTP: one-time programmable. AVSBus: adaptive voltage scaling bus. PVT: process, voltage, temperature.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version	Date	Author	Change

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